

Joey Low
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Education

Ph.D. in History, Brandeis University, 2026
M.A. in History, California State University, Fullerton, 2018
B.A. in History, California State University, Bakersfield, 2015

Publications

“Unmaking the China-Vietnam Boundary: Hostility, Friendship, and Possession in Early Modern Eurasian Buffer Zones,” forthcoming in *Journal of the Economic and Social History of the Orient*

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

External

Geiss Hsu Annual Conference Travel Grant, Association for Asian Studies, 2026
Geiss Hsu Travel Grant, SEUSS-FLIC, 2026
Library Travel Grant, University of Chicago Center for East Asian Studies, 2026
Research Student Attachment Programme, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, 2024-25
East and Inner Asia Council Grant, Association for Asian Studies/Chiang Ching-Kuo Foundation, 2024
New Voices in Ming Studies Travel and Presentation Grant, James P. Geiss and Margaret Y. Hsu Foundation, 2023
East Asia Library Travel Grant, IFLE, ED, Stanford University, 2023
RaceB4Race Social Media Fellow, Arizona Center for Medieval and Renaissance Studies, Arizona State University/Brandeis University, 2023
RBS Field School for Late Imperial Chinese History, University of California, Los Angeles/Harvard University/California Institute of Technology, 2022
Genevan Paleography Workshop, Calvin University, 2021 [Fund Cancelled for Virtual Workshop]

Internal

Graduate Student Association Travel and Research Grant, Brandeis University, 2024, 2023, 2021, 2019
PhD Conference Award, Brandeis University, 2024
Mandel Writing Retreat, Brandeis University, 2024
Summer Dissertation Writing Grant, Brandeis University, 2023
PhD Research Award, Brandeis University, (March) 2022, (November) 2022
Crown Summer Stipend, Brandeis University, 2022, 2021
Mandel Center Dissertation Research Award, Brandeis University, 2022
Provost Doctoral Research Award, Brandeis University, 2022
Doctoral Travel Funds, Brandeis University, 2019-2020
Irving and Rose Crown Fellowship, Brandeis University Department of History, 2018-2023

Conference Presentations

Invited Presentations

- “A Native Official Arms Dealer in the Upper Tongking Gulf Region during the Early 16th Century.”
Charting Maritime East Asia: State-Building, Networks, and Environment (Huizhi Haiyang Dongya: Guojia Jiangou, Wangluo he huanjing). The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. May 2-3, 2025
- “Learning History at Two California State Universities: My Own Experiences at Bakersfield and Fullerton.” International Conference on History Education: How is History Taught? Local, National, and/or Global Perspectives. California State University, Fullerton. April 29, 2018

Presentations

- “Constellations in the China-Vietnam Borderlands: Rethinking the Native Officials (Tuguan) as Mandala Rulers in the Early Modern Period.” American Historical Association Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA. January, 2027
- “Unmaking the China-Vietnam Border: Hostility, Friendship, and Sovereignty in Early Modern Asian Borderlands.” Forum on Early-Modern Empires and Global Interactions (FEEGI). Rutgers University. April 10-11, 2026,
- “Cantonese Collaboration and Native Official Trade in the Early Modern Upper Tongking Gulf Region.” Annual Meeting of the Association for Asian Studies. Vancouver, BC. March 12-15, 2026
- “Unmaking the China-Vietnam Border: Hostility, Friendship, and Sovereignty in Early Modern Asian Borderlands.” Technologies of Scholarship, Ming and Beyond, Southeast US Scholars and Friends of Late Imperial China (SEUSS-FLIC). Georgia Tech. January 23, 2026
- “Bắc Tiên Bô là ai? Phân tích phê phán *Lịch triều hiến chương loại chí* và cách diễn giải mới về lịch sử nhà Lê” (Who was Bắc Tiên Bô 北先布? A Critical Analysis of the *Lịch triều Hiến chương Loại Chí* and a New Interpretation of Lê History). Tư liệu Hán-Nôm: sưu tầm, bảo quản, nghiên cứu và khai thác (The Sino-Nom Archives: Collection, Preservation, Research and Exploitation). Institute of Social Sciences Information, Vietnam Academy of Social Sciences. May 7, 2025
- “Extortion and Labor in the China-Vietnam Borderlands, 1475-1522.” 30th Columbia University Graduate Student Conference on East Asia. Columbia University. October 18-19, 2024
- “Jackals before the Gate to the Esteemed Kingdom: Extortion and Labor Politics in the China-Vietnam Borderlands, 1475-1522.” Western Conference of the Association for Asian Studies. Weber State. October 11-12, 2024
- “Before Bureaucratization: Native Officials and Crime in the Early Modern China-Vietnam Borderlands.” Ming Studies, Association for Asian Studies in Boston. March 17th. 2023
- “Ming China in Vietnam and Valois France in Italy: Political Actors and Public Narratives of Invasion and Occupation in the Premodern World.” 2020 Multidisciplinary Graduate Conference. Newberry Library. January 23-25, 2020
- “Fall of the Ming: Natural, Internal, and External Problems.” Phi Alpha Theta Regional Conference. Point Loma Nazarene University. April 2015

Research Experiences

- Research Contractor. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, 2026
- Visiting Research Student. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, 2024-25
- Archival Research at EFEO, Société asiatique, Musée Guimet, 2024
- Archival Research at Hán-Nôm Institute Library, Guangxi Provincial Library, 2023
- Research Assistant. Brandeis, 2022
- Cai, Lesley...Yu Feng, [et al., including **Joey Low**]. *A Lexicon of Chinese Correspondence of Literary Style with English Translation and Notes*. E-book, Brandeis University, 2019.
<https://www.brandeis.edu/grall/chinese/a-lexicon-of-chinese-correspondence-of-literary-style-with-english-translation-and-notes-1.pdf>
- Research Assistant Intern. CSUF, 2016

Teaching Experience

Brandeis University

Lecturer: Fall 2023: *Frenemy States: Identity and Integration in East Asia*

- Supervisor, BA Honors Thesis/Papers/Projects.

Teaching Assistant: Fall 2021: *Medieval England*; Spring 2021: *Colonialism, Slavery and Freedom: Latin America and the Caribbean*; Fall 2020: *East Asian Civilization to 1700*; Spring 2020: *State and Society in Early Modern Europe (1500-1700)*; Fall 2019: *Introduction to Asian Civilization*

Brandeis Osher Lifelong Learning Institute (BOLLI)

Instructor (designed and sole-taught courses for lifelong learners): Fall 2021: *The Making of Modern China, 1900 to the Present*; Fall 2020: *The Rise of the West: China and Europe in the Gunpowder Age*

California State University, Fullerton

Teaching Assistant Intern: Fall 2016: *World Civilizations since the 16th Century* (2 sections)

Professional Service

Panel Organizer, “Rethinking Imperial China’s ‘Native Officials’ (Tuguan): Sovereignty and Negotiation in the Sino-Southeast Asian Borderlands.” With Co-Sponsorship from Chinese Historians of the United States. 2027 Annual Meeting of the American Historical Association.

Panel Organizer, “Reshaping Sea and Hinterland: New Perspectives of Imperial China from the Southern Expanse.” 2026 Annual Meeting of the Association for Asian Studies

Assistant organizer, Charting Maritime East Asia: State-Building, Networks, and Environment (Huizhi Haiyang Dongya: Guojia Jiangou, Wangluo he huanjing). The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. May 2025

Organizer, guest speaker at Brandeis, “Documenting Martial Law: Human Rights Archives under the Marcos Dictatorship,” by Prof. Mark John Sanchez. February 2025

Co-organizer and member, working group “Ming-Qing Field School Writing Group.” 2022-2024

Membership in Organizations

American Historical Association

Association for Asian Studies

Chinese Historians of the United States

Phi Alpha Theta

The Forum on Early-Modern Empires and Global Interactions (FEEGI)

Languages

English, French, Mandarin, Classical Chinese, Vietnamese, Cantonese, Spanish, Japanese, German